Quince

Team G27

Own the Second Purchase

Turning viral first buyers into repeat customers, inside the same $120M

Retargeting and lifecycle strategy · Grounded in Adobe Customer Journey Analytics

Case Competition World Cup · Graduate Track · October 2026

Win the second purchase inside the same $120M

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The company
Quince sells premium basics 50%+ below branded prices, shipped direct from its factories (M2C). Viral TikTok and Instagram moments made it one of the fastest-growing US apparel brands.

The problem
First buyers don't come back: 90-day repeat is 24% vs 30–35% for peers, while blended CAC rose $48 → $62. 60% of the $120M budget rents reach from social platforms.

The question
With a fixed $120M, no price cuts and Adobe CJA as the evidence base, how does Quince lift repeat by 6+ points and cut CAC by 10%+ in 12–18 months?

We believe in blending the three options: precise paid retargeting (B) starts it, owned lifecycle (A) builds repeat, CJA holdouts (C) decide every budget move

Lever 1 Capture every buyer

Every buyer into email, SMS or the app

★ **Quince Passport:** box card registering each piece for care and restock alerts

Only 24.5% of buyers engage, yet they are 66% of repeaters (A2)

Lever 2 Win the Golden Month

Care first, then a second category, weeks 1–4

★ **Material Journeys:** how the material is made and cared for, then cashmere → home

Week-2 repeat 5.6% engaged vs 2.1% all; cashmere repeats least, 13.7% (Cohort, A6)

Lever 3 Never pay twice

Stop paying for ads that reach buyers Quince can message

★ **Never Pay Twice Engine:** CJA audiences become daily ad suppression lists

Retargeted buyers repeat no better than organic: 23.0% vs 23.4% (A3b)

No new money: rented → owned

A: $2–3M from the $6M owned line
B: inside the $14M retargeting line
Then retargeting → search → prospecting move to owned, as holdouts prove

Impact on the case's targets

90-day repeat 24% → 30%+
Blended CAC −10% or better
Needs ~29% of buyers moved into the app, plus category and cart lift (appendix 22)

All three constraints met

- **No budget increase**
- **No price-led retention**
- **Grounded in Adobe CJA**

Source: case sections 1, 3 and Exhibits G, I, J; Adobe CJA (A2, A3b, A6, Cohort Table), appendix 9–13.

Rented ad platforms get costlier as demand weakens

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~$180B
US online apparel, accessories and home; growing mid-single digits (case, illustrative)

17.1%
of US retail sales were online in Q2 2026; e-commerce grew 12.2% vs 6.7% for all retail (Census)

71%
of consumers expect personalized interactions; 76% are frustrated without them (McKinsey)

Four forces reshaping how DTC brands reach customers

Signal loss

Only 35–50% of iOS users allow tracking (Adjust; AppsFlyer)

So what: Retargeting sees, and proves, less

Platforms automate

Meta defaults to Advantage+; TikTok US has new owners (2026)

So what: Less control, more platform risk

Reach costs more

Meta price per ad +12% year on year (Q2 2026)

So what: Every new customer is dearer

Cautious consumer

Sentiment at a record low in 2026 (UMich); tariffs lift prices

So what: Every buyer kept matters more

The industry's answer

Case Exhibit B; McKinsey; Gordon et al.

First-party data wins
Own the customer, escape signal loss

Measure by experiment
Attribution can miss true lift (Gordon)

Personalize the journey
Leaders earn 40% more from it (McKinsey)

Privacy tightens
CCPA limits how identity is unified

Where Quince is exposed

- 60% of the $120M sits on Meta, TikTok and Pinterest (Exhibit G)
- Retargeting is templated ads; email is batch-and-blast (case s. 1)
- CAC $48 → $62 (+29%); repeat 24% vs 30–35% (case s. 3)

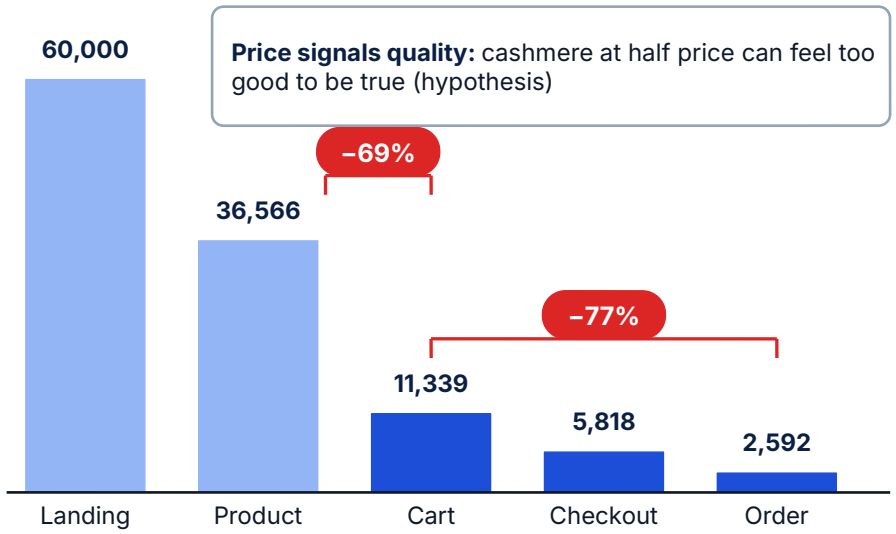
Source: case section 2, Exhibit B; US Census Bureau (Q2 2026); Adjust (Q2 2025); AppsFlyer (Apr 2025); Google (Apr 2025); Meta Q2 2026 results; TikTok USDS JV (Jan 2026); UMich Surveys of Consumers (2026); Cotton Inc. (Jun 2026); McKinsey (2021); Gordon et al. (2019). Links in appendix 27.

Quince rents reach, then loses most shoppers at the cart

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Where the funnel breaks

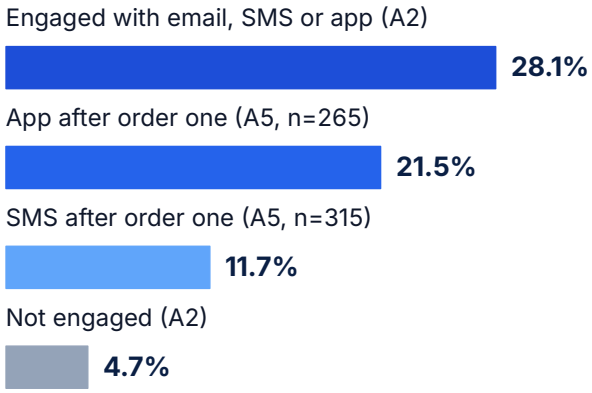
People at each step (Fallout)



Only 1 of ~5,500 cart paths that stop before checkout gets an email next (Flow)

Who comes back

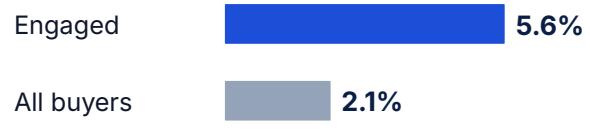
Repeat rate in the CJA window



24.5% of buyers engage, yet they are **66%** of repeat buyers (A2)

When, and what next

Repeat orders in week 2 (Cohort)



Half of engaged repeats land in weeks 1–4

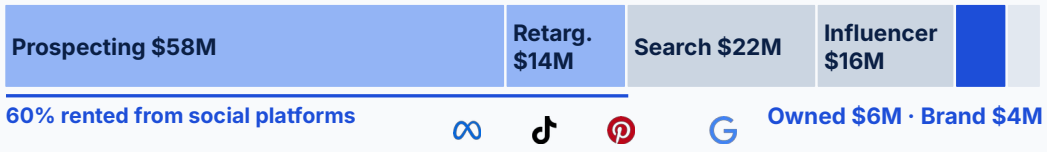
Repeat by category touched (A6)



Cashmere: touched by 40.7% of buyers, repeats least

Where the $120M goes

FY2026 (Exhibit G)



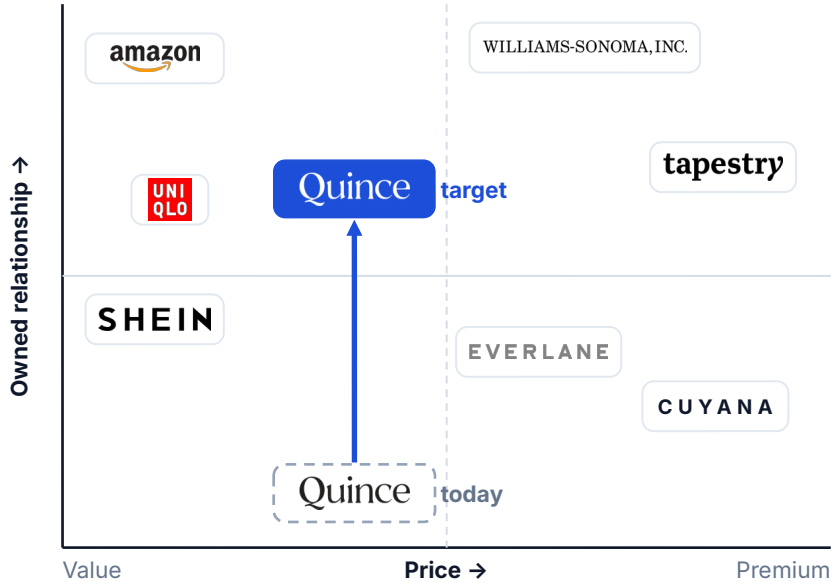
5% owned: $1.43 per active customer (A, G). **$31** retargeting CAC counts sales that would happen anyway (D)

Source: Adobe CJA, Quince Case Data View, 1 Jan–30 Apr 2026 (Fallout A1, segments A2/A5, Flow A4, Cohort Table, A6), appendix 9–13; case Exhibits A, D, G. CJA repeat covers ~3 months, so it is used for relative gaps, not vs the case's 24%.

Rivals can copy discounts, not M2C cost plus owned reach

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Price vs depth of owned relationship (team judgment)



What a rival can copy, and how fast

A 20% discount	Overnight: any rival, any day
Journeys and suppression lists	A quarter or two: Everlane ran them and still sold
M2C cost + consented audience	Years: own factories plus buyers who opted in

Rival	What they do (evidence)	What it means for Quince
amazon	Ads revenue $19.8B in Q2 2026, +26%	**Wins any retargeting auction**
SHEIN	#2 shopping app worldwide; buying Everlane	**The price end is crowded**
EVERLANE	Mature email and SMS, still sold to Shein	**Owned channels alone aren't a moat**
UNIQLO	App loyalty; 13.5M members in China	**Data scale Quince can't copy**
tapestry	6.8M new US customers, ~60% Gen Z/Millennial	**Data wins young buyers**
WILLIAMS-SONOMA, INC.	The Key loyalty; sued Quince over "dupes"	**Trust must come from proof**
CUYANA	Owned-channel loyalty, little paid (Exh. M)	**Closest to our target**

Source: case Exhibit M, section 7; Amazon Q2 2026 results; Sensor Tower via CNBC (2025) and State of Mobile 2026; Bloomberg Law, NPR (May 2026); Fast Retailing FY2025; Tapestry FY2025 results; Williams-Sonoma 10-K; The Fashion Law (30 Sep 2026). Map positions are team judgment.

Quince has the CJA identity data; now it must activate it

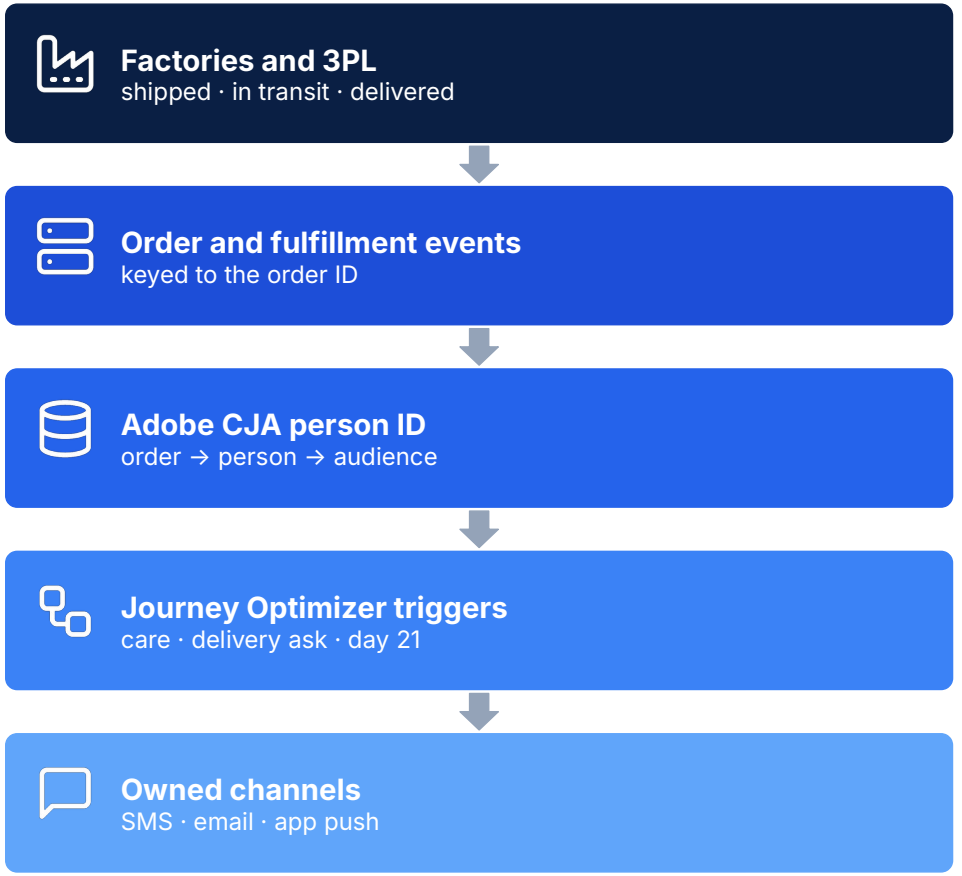
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Readiness against what the plan needs

Data and identity	Partial	Person ID is stitched (Exhibit L); fix owned-event logging and attribution set-up in month 1
Activation	Gap	Real-Time CDP (ads) and Journey Optimizer (messages), from Option A's $2–3M
Lifecycle and creative	Gap	Email is batch-and-blast: lifecycle team and creative, same budget
Growth–analytics	Gap	CJA is new: one weekly council, one holdout rule
App	Partial	22% of sessions (Exhibit A): add tracking and restock alerts
Shipping events	Partial	Quince ships direct: confirm 3PL events carry the order ID
Privacy and consent	Partial	CCPA: split transactional and marketing SMS consent

How shipping events become journeys

Material Journeys, end to end (appendix 24)



Source: case sections 1, 3, 4, 7; Exhibits A, I, K, L. Status is team assessment against the case. Adobe CJA analyses audiences; activation runs through Real-Time CDP or Journey Optimizer (Adobe Experience League).

We will prove the model in a 90-day pilot before scaling

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Lever	Built with	Set up · wk 1–4	Launch · wk 5–8	Measure · wk 9–12	Paid from
1 Capture every buyer 77% of cart adders never order; only 24.5% engage	SMS at checkout App order tracking Email reminders	Consent split; CJA abandoner segment; Passport cards	SMS opt-in, app tracking, cart reminders at 1h and 24h	**Cart recovery; opt-ins per 100 orders**	**$6M owned line** Option A's $2–3M (Exhibit I)
Programs	★ Quince Passport · Track It in the App · Saved Cart · Restock-First Waitlist				
2 Win the Golden Month Repeat peaks in week 2; cashmere repeats least, 13.7%	Shipping events Journey Optimizer Email + app push	Delivery events to person ID; care and next-category content	Care guide at delivery; second category by day 21	**30-day and week-2 repeat**	**$6M owned line** same Option A budget
Programs	★ Material Journeys v1 · Care Calendar · Gift Ledger · Quince Insider · Beauty Refill · Cashmere Second Life				
3 Never pay twice Retargeted buyers repeat 23.0%, same as organic 23.4%	CJA audiences Real-Time CDP Meta, Google, TikTok	Recent and owned-reachable buyers as CJA audiences	Daily suppression lists; frequency caps	**Incremental orders per retargeting $**	**$14M retargeting line** re-aimed, $0 incremental
Programs	★ Never Pay Twice Engine · Proof Creators · Loyalist Lookalikes · The Fitting Room				

■ in the 90-day pilot (★ flagship) ▭ after day 90, if the holdout passes

14 programs · 0 discounts

Rented → owned
inside the fixed $120M

After day 90
Retargeting → owned
up to $3.4M (24.5% × $14M)

Months 4–6
Branded search → owned
test ~$6.2M (South 28% × $22M)

Months 7–9
Prospecting → owned
test ~$16.2M (South 28% × $58M)

Each step moves only **what its holdout proves**; scale, adjust or stop

Source: case Exhibits G (budget), I (cost by option), N (regions); Adobe CJA A1, A2, A3b, A6, Cohort Table. Pilot design and sequencing are the team's. South test sizes assume spend follows the customer split (South 28%, Exhibit N). 10% randomized South holdout throughout.

Appendix

ADOBE CJA EVIDENCE

9 Fallout

10 Attribution IQ

11 Cohort Table

12 Flow

13 Segments

BACKUP ANALYSIS

14 Why a blend

15 Issue tree

16 Seven moments of the journey

17 Every cart adder's path (flowchart)

18 Never Pay Twice engine

19 The weekly CJA loop

20 Fourteen programs, explained

21 How the $120M moves, line by line

22 What +6 points takes

23 Attribution IQ insight

24 Material Journeys build plan

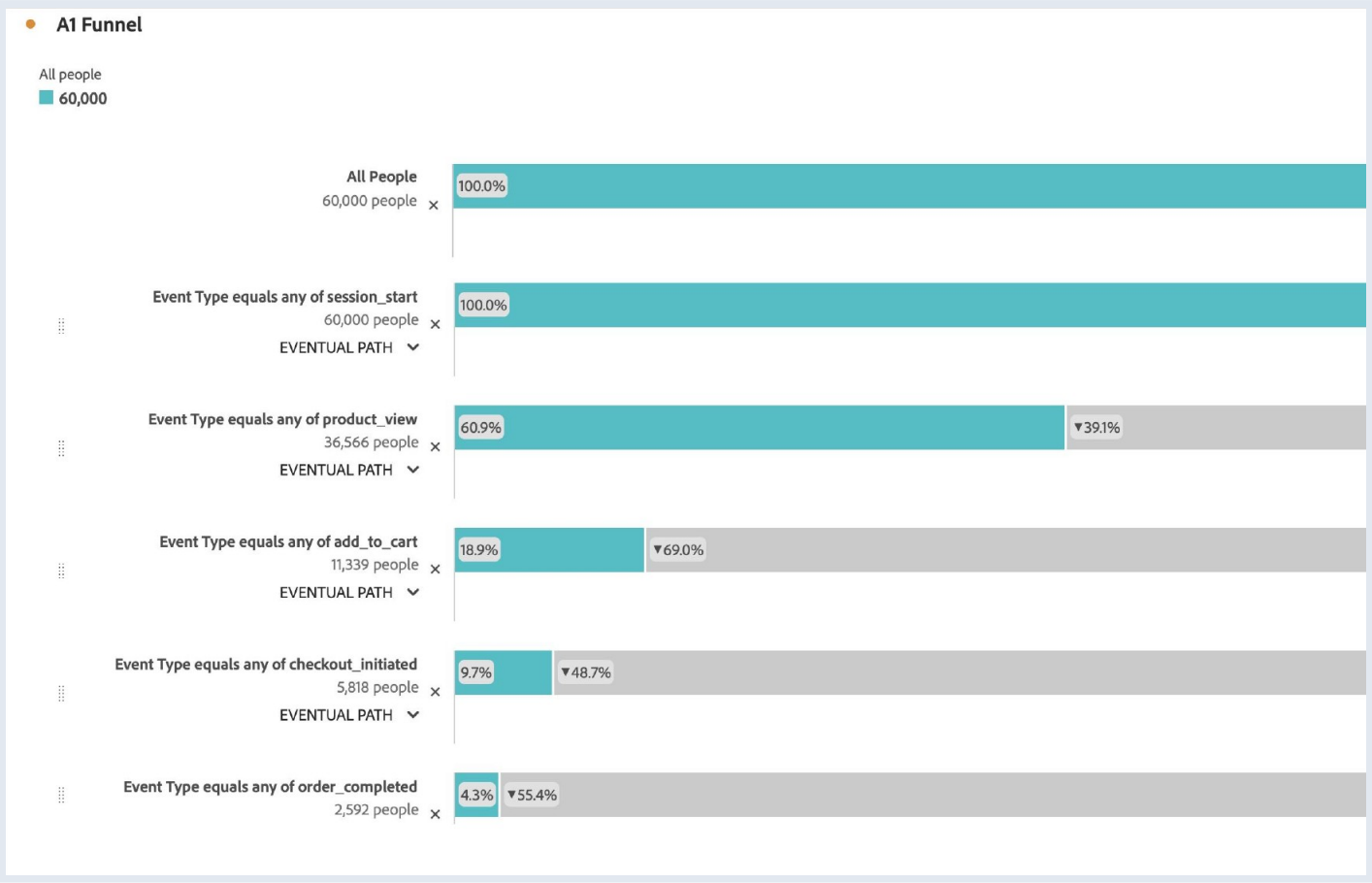
25 Risks

26 Every number and its source

27 Sources

Fallout: 77% of cart adders never order

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77% of cart adders never order, against a ~70% category benchmark (Exhibit C): the cart is where Quince underperforms, so every recovered cart is new money

Source: Adobe CJA, Fallout, Quince Case Data View, 1 Jan–30 Apr 2026, 60,000 people. 69% of product viewers never add to cart.

Attribution IQ: owned channels assist more than they close

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Order Revenue Attribution Comparison

Marketing Channel Page: 1/ 1 Rows: 10 1-8 of 8	Order Revenue Last Touch | Person | 90 Days Jan 1 – Apr 30 $337,044 out of $337,044	Order Revenue First Touch | Person | 90 Days Jan 1 – Apr 30 $337,044 out of $337,044	Order Revenue Linear | Person | 90 Days Jan 1 – Apr 30 $337,044 out of $337,044	Order Revenue Participation | Person | 90 Days Jan 1 – Apr 30 $337,044 out of $337,044
1. Paid Social Prospecting	$139,932 41.5%	$143,356 42.5%	$143,588 42.6%	$153,968 45.7%
2. Organic / Direct / SEO	$53,763 16.0%	$47,758 14.2%	$50,192 14.9%	$56,763 16.8%
3. Paid Social Retargeting	$43,395 12.9%	$41,836 12.4%	$42,278 12.5%	$47,416 14.1%
4. Paid Search	$43,231 12.8%	$44,978 13.3%	$43,930 13.0%	$46,180 13.7%
5. Influencer / Affiliate	$40,814 12.1%	$42,991 12.8%	$42,049 12.5%	$44,820 13.3%
6. Email	$9,063 2.7%	$10,546 3.1%	$8,829 2.6%	$29,408 8.7%
7. App Push	$4,656 1.4%	$2,562 0.8%	$3,555 1.1%	$9,631 2.9%
8. SMS	$2,192 0.7%	$3,018 0.9%	$2,622 0.8%	$11,526 3.4%

Owned channels appear in up to 15.0% of revenue (participation, not additive) but get 4.8% of last-touch credit; retargeting barely moves across models, so only a holdout can prove its value

Source: Adobe CJA, Attribution IQ, Order Revenue ($337,044) by Marketing Channel; Last Touch, First Touch, Linear, Participation; 90-day lookback. Algorithmic model unavailable on this view.

Cohort Table: engaged buyers' week-2 repeat is 2.7× higher

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Cohort table

Retention

Inclusion: **Orders (Events)** >= 1 Return: **Orders (Events)** >= 1

Cohort	Included	+1 Weeks	+2 Weeks	+3 Weeks	+4 Weeks	+5 Weeks	+6 Weeks	+7 Weeks	+8 Weeks	+9 Weeks	+10 Weeks	+11 Weeks	+12 Weeks
Average retentio	201	3 1.3%	4 2.1%	3 1.4%	3 1.6%	3 1.3%	3 1.6%	3 1.3%	2 0.8%	3 1.7%	2 1.3%	1 0.6%	0 0.0%
Dec 28 - Jan 3	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0
Jan 4 - Jan 10	158	3 1.9%	5 3.2%	5 3.2%	5 3.2%	2 1.3%	5 3.2%	2 1.3%	0	4 2.5%	3 1.9%	2 1.3%	
Jan 11 - Jan 17	215	3 1.4%	6 2.8%	3 1.4%	4 1.9%	7 3.3%	1 0.5%	6 2.8%	4 1.9%	2 0.9%	4 1.9%		
Jan 18 - Jan 24	191	4 2.1%	5 2.6%	2 1.0%	2 1.0%	1 0.5%	6 3.1%	3 1.6%	2 1.0%	6 3.1%			
Jan 25 - Jan 31	239	1 0.4%	7 2.9%	5 2.1%	4 1.7%	4 1.7%	3 1.3%	1 0.4%	3 1.3%				
Feb 1 - Feb 7	190	1 0.5%	5 2.6%	2 1.1%	3 1.6%	2 1.1%	1 0.5%	3 1.6%					
Feb 8 - Feb 14	216	3 1.4%	4 1.9%	1 0.5%	3 1.4%	5 2.3%	5 2.3%						
Feb 15 - Feb 21	242	1 0.4%	3 1.2%	6 2.5%	4 1.7%	1 0.4%							
Feb 22 - Feb 28	212	2 0.9%	4 1.9%	2 0.9%	4 1.9%								
Mar 1 - Mar 7	246	4 1.6%	5 2.0%	4 1.6%									
Mar 8 - Mar 14	223	6 2.7%	4 1.8%										
Mar 15 - Mar 21	230	6 2.6%											
Mar 22 - Mar 28	249												

All buyers

Cohort table Engaged

Retention

Inclusion: **Orders (Events)** >= 1, **Engaged** Return: **Orders (Events)** >= 1

Cohort	Included	+1 Weeks	+2 Weeks	+3 Weeks	+4 Weeks	+5 Weeks	+6 Weeks	+7 Weeks	+8 Weeks	+9 Weeks	+10 Weeks	+11 Weeks	+12 Weeks
Average retentio	48	2 2.9%	3 5.6%	2 4.4%	2 4.0%	1 2.3%	2 3.1%	1 2.7%	1 1.7%	2 3.8%	1 2.3%	1 1.9%	0 0.0%
Dec 28 - Jan 3	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0
Jan 4 - Jan 10	52	3 5.8%	4 7.7%	4 7.7%	4 7.7%	0	3 5.8%	0	0	4 7.7%	2 3.8%	2 3.8%	
Jan 11 - Jan 17	63	1 1.6%	5 7.9%	3 4.8%	3 4.8%	4 6.3%	1 1.6%	3 4.8%	4 6.3%	2 3.2%	2 3.2%		
Jan 18 - Jan 24	47	2 4.3%	3 6.4%	1 2.1%	1 2.1%	1 2.1%	2 4.3%	3 6.4%	1 2.1%	2 4.3%			
Jan 25 - Jan 31	49	1 2.0%	2 4.1%	3 6.1%	3 6.1%	2 4.1%	2 4.1%	0	0				
Feb 1 - Feb 7	42	0	3 7.1%	2 4.8%	2 4.8%	0	0	2 4.8%					
Feb 8 - Feb 14	51	1 2.0%	3 5.9%	1 2.0%	0	2 3.9%	3 5.9%						
Feb 15 - Feb 21	59	0	2 3.4%	5 8.5%	3 5.1%	1 1.7%							
Feb 22 - Feb 28	57	2 3.5%	3 5.3%	2 3.5%	3 5.3%								
Mar 1 - Mar 7	61	3 4.9%	5 8.2%	3 4.9%									
Mar 8 - Mar 14	59	3 5.1%	3 5.1%										
Mar 15 - Mar 21	53	3 5.7%											
Mar 22 - Mar 28	31												

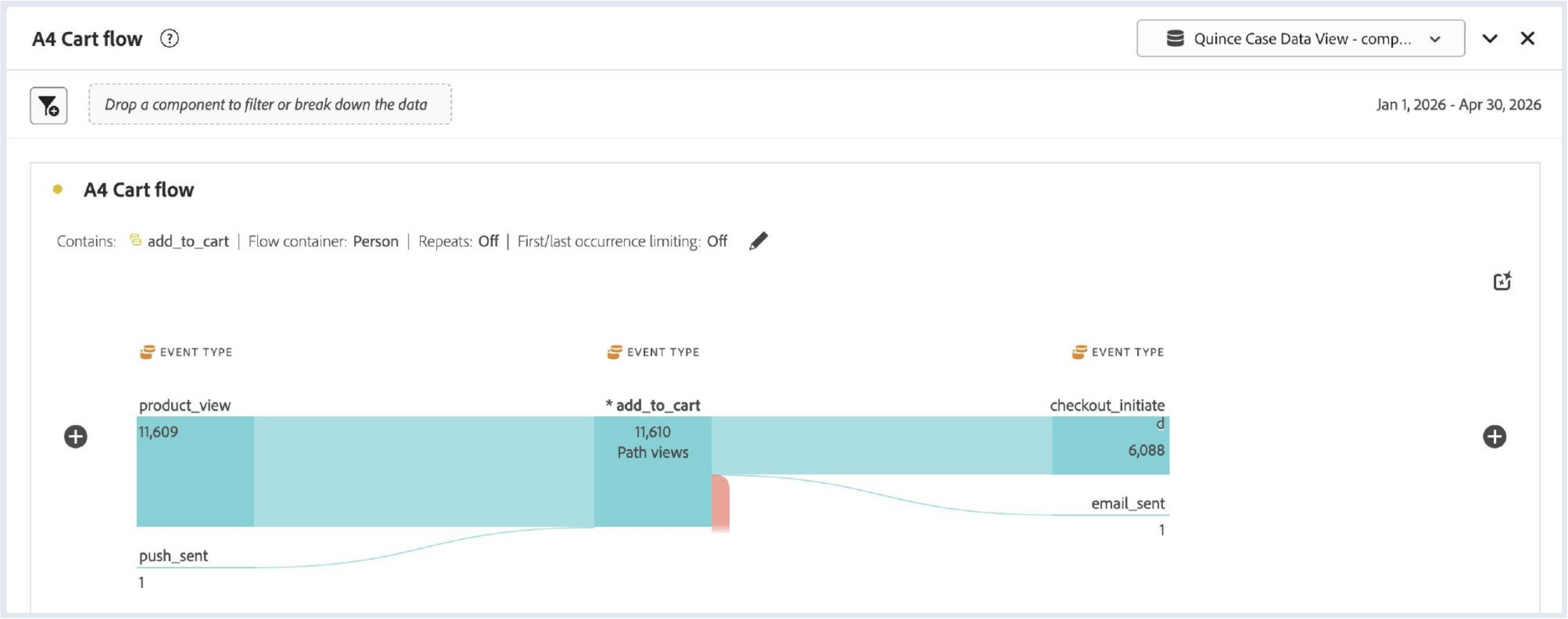
Engaged buyers (inclusion segment)

Engaged buyers repeat 2.7× more in week 2 than all buyers (5.6% vs 2.1%), and half their repeats land in weeks 1–4; cohorts are small (~48 engaged buyers a week), so read as directional

Source: Adobe CJA, Cohort Table, inclusion and return Orders ≥ 1, weekly, 1 Jan–30 Apr 2026; right panel uses the Engaged inclusion segment.

Flow: almost no message follows an abandoned cart

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Of 11,610 cart paths, 6,088 continue to checkout and only 1 is followed next by an email: a basic cart-recovery journey is the fastest win

Source: Adobe CJA, Flow from add_to_cart (next step), Person container, 1 Jan–30 Apr 2026. 11,610 = path views; 11,339 = people (Fallout).

Segments: engagement after order one is linked to repeat

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A2 · Repeat by engagement (any time)

A5 · Engaged after order one

A2 Repeat by engagement

Segments Page: 1/ 1 Rows: 400 1-4 of 4	Buyers People Jan 1 – Apr 30 2,592	Repeat buyers People Jan 1 – Apr 30 271
1. Engaged	636 24.5%	179 66.1%
2. SMS engaged	319 12.3%	59 21.8%
3. Email engaged	74 2.9%	74 27.3%
4. App engaged	266 10.3%	69 25.5%

A5 Engaged before repeat

Segments Page: 1/ 1 Rows: 400 1-4 of 4	People Jan 1 – Apr 30 674
1. Order then App	265 39.3%
2. Order then App then Order	57 8.5%
3. Order then SMS	315 46.7%
4. Order then SMS then Order	37 5.5%

Engaged buyers are 24.5% of buyers but 66% of repeaters (A2 overstates: owned visits log only at purchase); after order one, app users still repeat 21.5% vs 11.7% for SMS (A5, the cleaner test)

Source: Adobe CJA, freeform tables with engagement segments (A2) and sequential segments after order one (A5, n = 265 app, 315 SMS), 1 Jan–30 Apr 2026.

Each option covers another's weakness, so we blend all three

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B Option B

Paid precision and suppression

- ✓ Results in weeks, $0 incremental
- ✗ Alone: High signal-loss exposure; builds no lasting relationship

A Option A

Owned lifecycle precision

- ✓ Lowest cost per touch; insulated from ATT
- ✗ Alone: Reach capped by today's list: 1 in 4 buyers engaged

C Option C

Attribution-based reallocation

- ✓ The lasting decision framework
- ✗ Alone: 6–12 months to trust; high change risk

Proves fast
Savings held in the $14M line until a holdout proves them

Builds it
Capture grows the list; journeys earn order two

Proves it
Runs from day 1 and decides every tranche

B gives fast proof, A's owned reach cuts B's signal-loss exposure, and C's holdouts remove the measurement risk of both

→ **Scale only what beats the CJA holdout; stop anything that doesn't and return to plan**

Source: case section 4 (Options A, B, C), Exhibit I (cost and timing) and Exhibit K (risk matrix); team analysis.

Four branches, three levers, one thread

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Why is 90-day repeat 24% and blended CAC $62 on a fixed $120M?

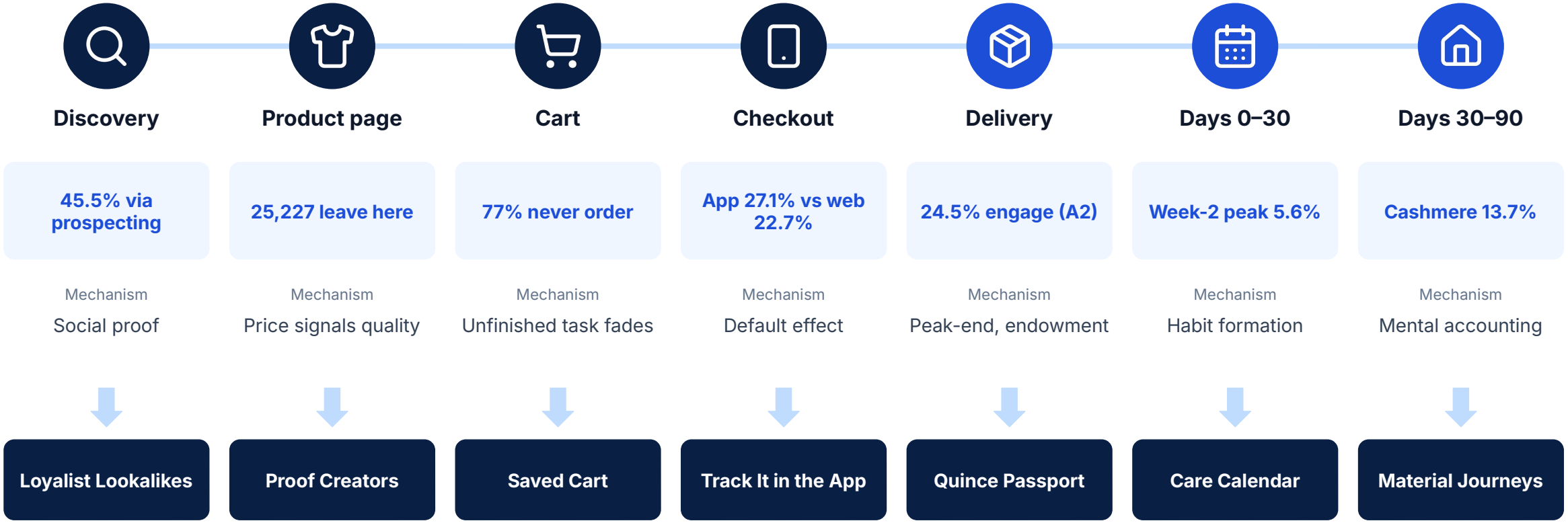
Money	**Spend may pay for demand that comes anyway** Retargeted buyers repeat no better than organic: 23.0% vs 23.4% (A3b); a holdout will tell	**Never pay twice**
Customer mind	**One-product buyers** Cashmere is touched by 40.7% of buyers but repeats 13.7% (A6)	**Win the Golden Month**
Customer journey	**The purchase leaks** 77% of cart adders never order; 1 of ~5,500 cart paths stopping before checkout gets an email (A1, A4)	**Capture every buyer**
Brand trust	**Found, not yet trusted** 25,227 people leave after a product view (A1)	**Trust thread, all levers**

→ **Repeat = engaged share × engaged repeat + non-engaged share × non-engaged repeat; CAC = $120M ÷ new customers**

Source: team analysis; Adobe CJA panels A1–A6 and A3b; case Exhibits D and G.

Seven moments decide whether a first buyer returns

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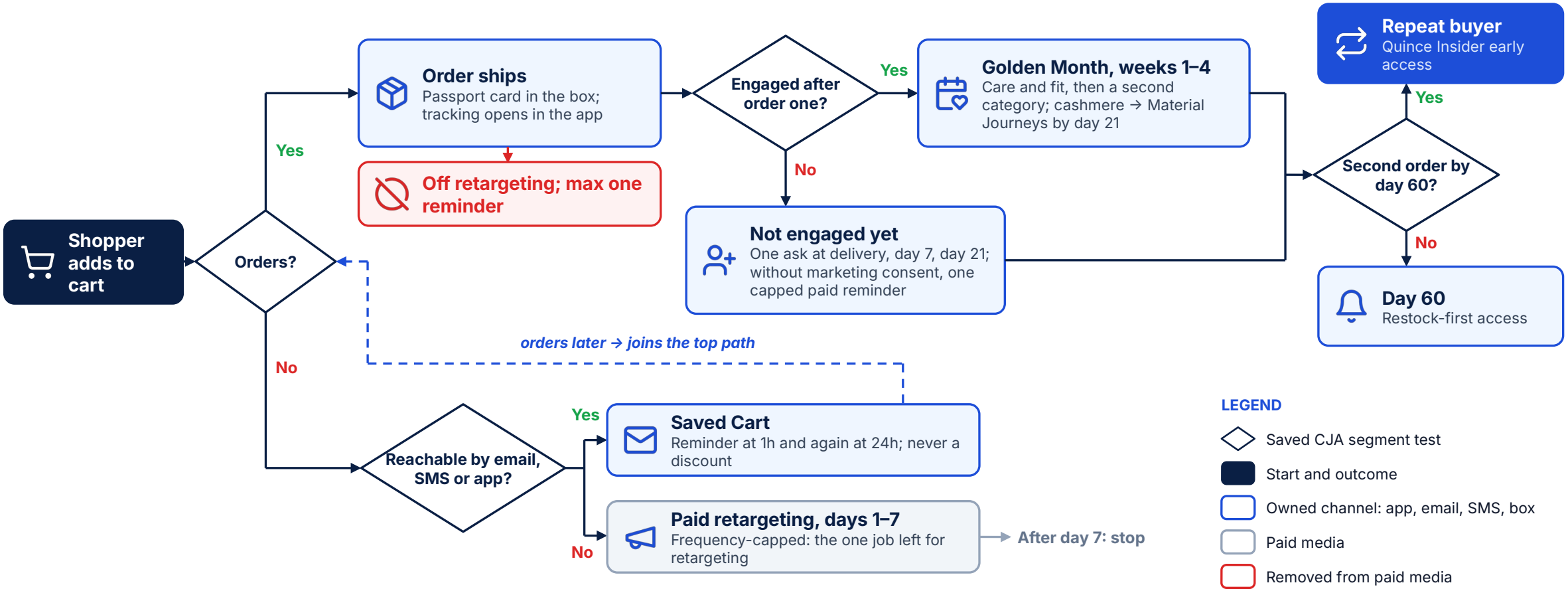


Trust peaks when the parcel opens: Quince asks for the relationship then, and never with a discount

Source: Adobe CJA panels A1, A2, A4, A5, A6 and Cohort Table; mechanisms are hypotheses the pilot tests.

Every cart adder follows exactly one path, owned first

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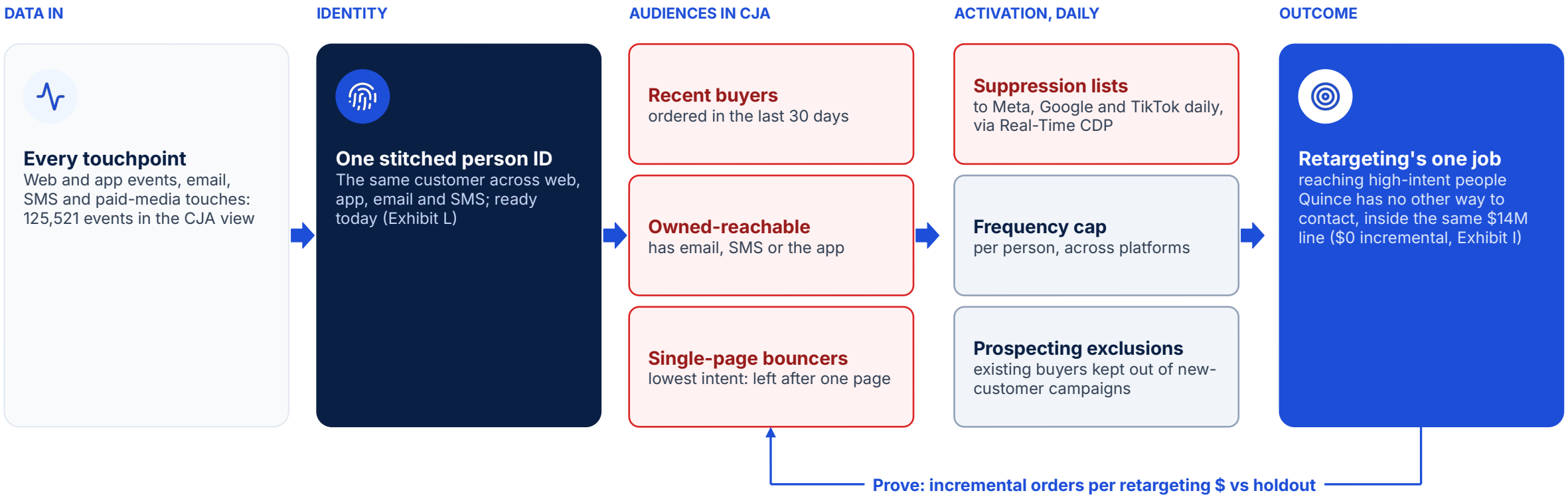


Each diamond is a saved CJA segment, so one rule drives both the message and its measurement

Source: Adobe CJA segments (A1, A2, A4, A6, Cohort Table); team targeting design. Message timings are pilot design choices, tested against the holdout.

Never Pay Twice: stop buying customers Quince already has

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Why test it: retargeted buyers repeat no better than organic (23.0% vs 23.4%, A3b) and attribution barely moves, so only a holdout can prove retargeting's value; the prospecting budget, which brings 45.5% of buyers, is unchanged.

Suppression stops paying for customers Quince can already message; the prospecting budget is unchanged

Source: Adobe CJA, Quince Case Data View (125,521 events, 1 Jan–30 Apr 2026), segments A3b and A1; case Exhibits D, I, L; team design.

One CJA loop runs every lever, every week

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1 Diagnose

Option C

Read Fallout, Flow, Cohort Table and Attribution IQ on one stitched person ID

OWNER **Head of Analytics**
RHYTHM Weekly

2 Target

Options A + B

Turn findings into saved CJA segments: abandoners, engaged, cashmere-first, recent buyers

OWNER **Analytics + CRM**
RHYTHM Weekly

3 Activate

Options A + B

Send segments to lifecycle journeys and to paid-media suppression lists

OWNER **Marketing ops**
RHYTHM Daily sync

4 Prove

Option C

Read every move against a randomized holdout: 10% in the South pilot

OWNER **Head of Analytics**
RHYTHM Weekly council

5 Reallocate

Option C

Move money across lines only when the holdout proves it; otherwise it stays

OWNER **CMO + CFO**
RHYTHM Gates: months 3, 9

What CJA proves sets the next diagnosis and the next move

Why it matters: Option C alone takes 6–12 months to trust (Exhibit I). Running it as a weekly loop from day one lets Options A and B act within weeks, with C deciding every budget move.

Growth and analytics share one workspace, one holdout and one decision rule

Source: case section 4 (Options A, B, C), Exhibits I and L; owners and rhythm are the team's operating design.

Fourteen programs, three flagships, zero discounts

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1 Capture every buyer

★ Quince Passport
A card in every box: scan to register the piece for care tips, easy exchange and restock alerts; it asks for SMS or the app

Track It in the App
Tracking opens in the app; app converts carts 27.1% vs 22.7% on web (A1)

Saved Cart
Reminders within hours of abandonment, with fit and return promises, never a discount

Restock-First Waitlist
"Text me when it's back" on real sell-outs: a reason to opt in

2 Win the Golden Month

★ Material Journeys
Before arrival, how the material is made and how to care for it (no supplier names); by day 21, a second category (cashmere → home)

Care Calendar
Seasonal care reminders keep cashmere buyers in touch

Gift Ledger
Customers save gift dates; picks arrive 14 days before

Quince Insider
Early access earned by engagement, not spend

Beauty Refill
Refill reminders timed to each product's use cycle

Cashmere Second Life
Take-back for recycling, rewarded with early access

3 Never pay twice

★ Never Pay Twice Engine
CJA suppression lists, synced daily to Meta, Google and TikTok, remove recent and owned-reachable buyers from paid retargeting

Loyalist Lookalikes
Prospecting seeded on repeat buyers, not one-time buyers

Proof Creators
Wear-tests and fabric close-ups instead of discount codes

The Fitting Room
Members-only pop-up for app users, one metro, one season: try fabrics in person; asset-light, no store

0 discounts

14 programs tested against a holdout

$0 new budget

Source: team strategy. Each program sits in one lever, works on one named behaviour and has a KPI CJA can read. No program uses a price cut.

How the fixed $120M moves from rented to owned

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LINE (EXHIBIT G)	WHAT CHANGES	EVIDENCE	DECISION RULE
Paid social prospecting $58M	Months 7–9: South test on ~$16.2M; existing buyers excluded, lookalikes on repeaters	Brings 45.5% of buyers (A3b) but its buyers repeat least, 18% (Exhibit D)	**Moves to owned only what the holdout shows is over-credited**
Paid search $22M	Months 4–6: South geo test on ~$6.2M of branded terms	Brand-keyword ads showed no short-term lift at eBay (Blake et al. 2015)	**Non-incremental branded spend moves to owned**
Influencer / affiliate $16M	Briefs shift to proof: wear-tests and fabric close-ups	Hypothesis; 69% product → cart drop (A1)	**No dollar move without a holdout**
Paid social retargeting $14M	Re-aimed inside the line: suppression and frequency caps	Repeats no better than organic, 23.0% vs 23.4% (A3b)	**After day 90: up to $3.4M (24.5% × $14M) moves to owned, as the holdout proves**
Email, SMS, app $6M	Option A: $2–3M of this line funds activation platform, lifecycle team, content and CRM	Engaged buyers repeat 28.1% vs 4.7% (A2)	**Receives every proven tranche**
Brand / other $4M	Unchanged; The Fitting Room tested only if it fits this line	Asset-light pop-up, no store	**One-season test; stopped if attendee repeat doesn't beat a matched holdout**

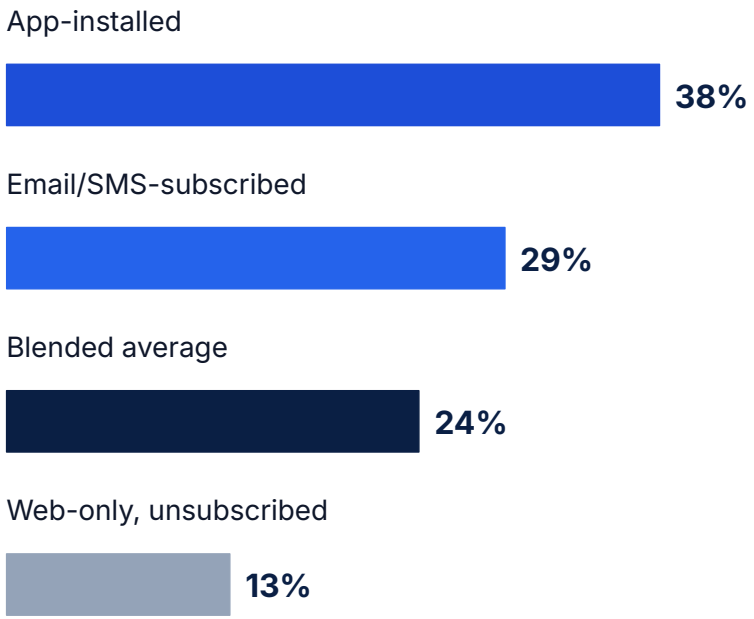
Net change: $0. Money leaves rented lines in three steps, each sized by what its holdout proves

Source: case Exhibits G (budget), I (cost by option), D (channel CAC), N (regions); Adobe CJA A3b, A2 and Attribution IQ. South test sizes assume spend follows the customer split (South 28%); final amounts are what each holdout proves.

What +6 points takes, in the case's own numbers

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90-day repeat by engagement (Exhibit E)



What it takes to add 6 points

24% → ~29%

of buyers moved web-only → app

each adds 25 pts (38 − 13); ~21 pts after the A5 selection haircut

37.5% → ~59%

of buyers moved web-only → email/SMS

each adds 16 pts; ~10 after haircut: more than the ≥31% who are web-only

Minimums: Exhibit E's lifts include selection (A2 any time → A5 after order one: app 25.9% → 21.5%, SMS 18.5% → 11.7%). Engagement mix only; category shift and cart recovery add lift on top

WHAT +6 POINTS IS WORTH (EXHIBIT J)

~250,000
incremental repeat orders a year

~$30M
incremental revenue

~$13.5M
contribution at ~45% margin

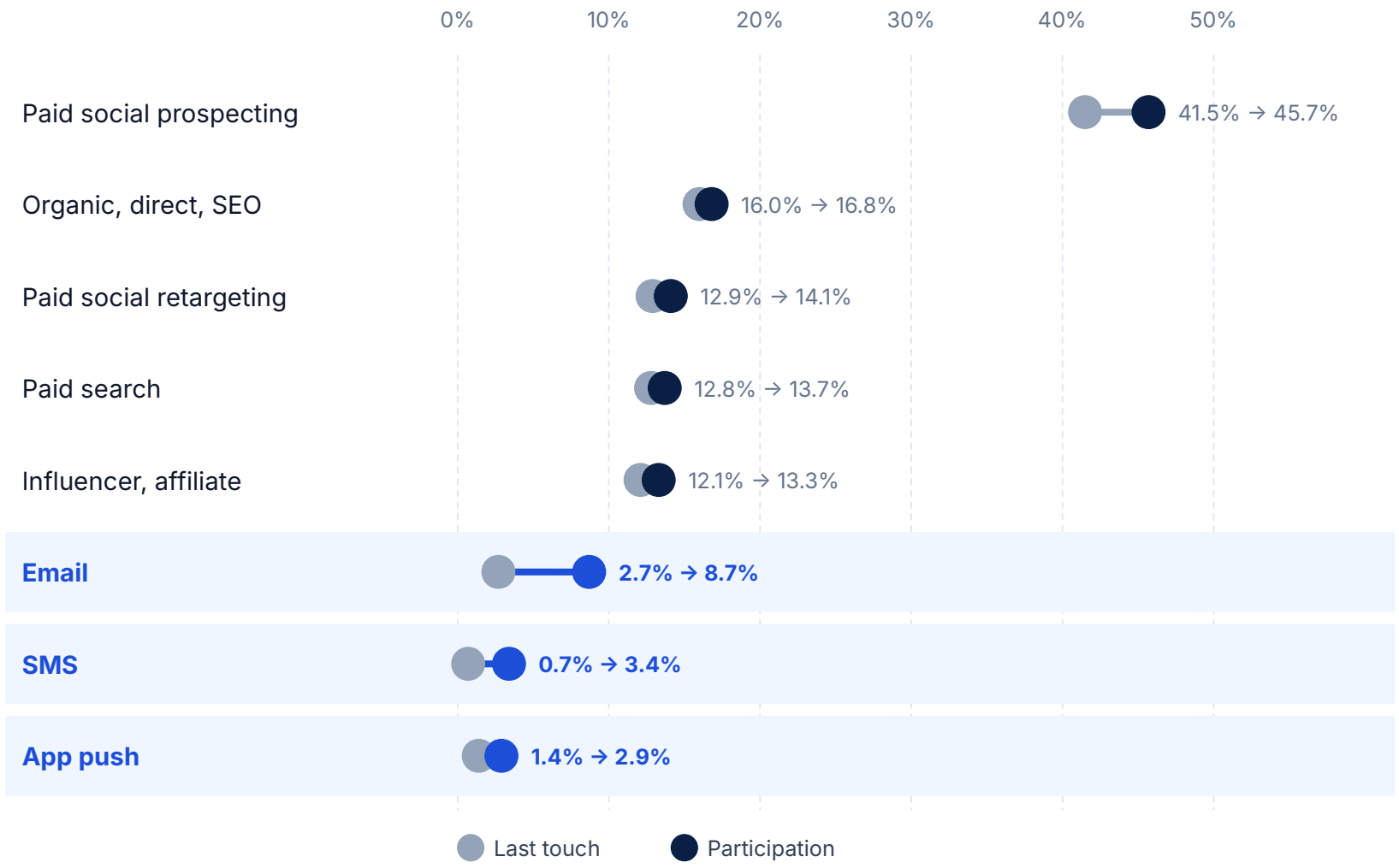
~10–12%
lower effective blended CAC

+6 points needs most web-only buyers moved into owned channels, the app route first: that is why lever 1 comes first

Source: case Exhibits E (90-day repeat by engagement type) and J (impact of a 6-point gain); Adobe CJA A5. Arithmetic on case figures, not a forecast.

Last click credits owned channels as little as a third

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4.8% → 15.0%

Owned channels: last-touch credit vs up to 15.0% of revenue they appear in (not additive)

12.9 · 12.4 · 12.5%

Retargeting under last touch, first touch and linear: attribution can't settle it; holdouts can (Gordon et al. 2019)

Source: Adobe CJA Attribution IQ, Order Revenue ($337,044), Marketing Channel, Person container, 90-day lookback, 1 Jan–30 Apr 2026.

Material Journeys reuses Quince's existing shipping events

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Factories and 3PL partners
Shipment created · customs cleared · out for delivery · delivered

↓

Order and fulfillment events
One event stream per order, keyed to the order ID

↓

Adobe CJA: stitched person ID
Order ID → person; audiences; holdout assignment

↓

Activation and journey triggers
Pre-arrival material and care guide · delivery-day Passport and app ask · day-21 next category

↓

Owned channels
SMS · email · app push, under one frequency cap

Build sequence, months 3–6 (after Gate 1)

1 Month 3–4 Map and consent

- List the shipping milestones factories and 3PLs already emit
- Agree one order-ID key with operations
- Split transactional and marketing SMS consent with Legal (CCPA)

2 Month 4–5 Connect

- Stream events into CJA: order ID → person ID
- Build audiences: in transit, delivered, day 21 with no second order
- Assign the 10% randomized holdout

3 Month 5–6 Launch and read

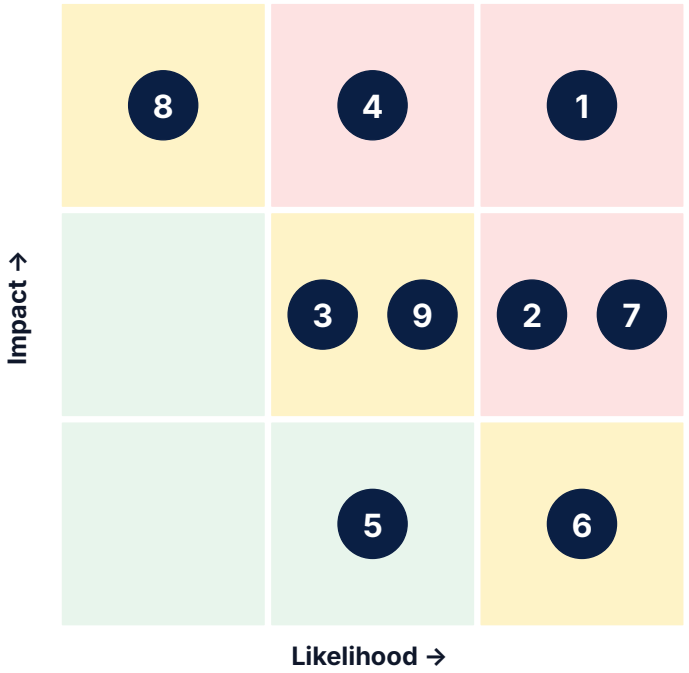
- Pre-arrival guide: how the material is made and cared for
- Delivery-day Passport and app ask; day-21 second category
- Read results against the holdout every week

→ The tech lift depends on one thing: 3PL shipping events keyed to an order ID

Source: case section 1 (M2C model), Exhibits L and N; team build plan. Month ranges are the team's plan, not case figures.

Nine risks, each with a mitigation and an early warning

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1	**Selection bias inflates lift**	**Mitigation:** Randomized 10% holdout **Early warning:** holdout gap shrinks
2	**Channel owners resist cuts**	**Mitigation:** Scorecards on incremental revenue **Early warning:** escalations at the weekly council
3	**Message fatigue, unsubscribes**	**Mitigation:** Fewer, triggered sends **Early warning:** unsubscribes above pre-pilot rate
4	**Consent and privacy (CCPA)**	**Mitigation:** Transactional and marketing consent split **Early warning:** consent complaints
5	**The Fitting Room doesn't pay back**	**Mitigation:** One-season test **Early warning:** attendee repeat no better than a matched holdout
6	**Platform or signal shock**	**Mitigation:** More owned reach; first-party lists **Early warning:** CPM or match-rate drop
7	**Creative fatigue**	**Mitigation:** Fresh creative funded by Option A **Early warning:** falling click and conversion rates
8	**Fewer new customers**	**Mitigation:** Prospecting budget unchanged; exclusions tested **Early warning:** weekly new customers vs plan
9	**Activation set-up slips**	**Mitigation:** Start in month 0; manual list upload as fallback **Early warning:** suppression lists not live by week 6

Source: case section 7 and Exhibit K; likelihood and impact positions are team judgment.

Every number in this deck, and where it comes from

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Case packet (illustrative)

- $120M budget and its six lines (Exhibit G); 4.2M active customers (A)
- CAC $48 → $62; repeat 24% vs 30–35% peers; targets +6 pts and −10% (section 3)
- Cart abandonment ~78% vs ~70% benchmark (C); retargeting CAC $31 (D)
- Repeat 38% / 29% / 13% by engagement (E); ~250K orders, ~$30M, ~$13.5M, ~10–12% CAC (J)
- Option A $2–3M inside the $6M owned line; B $0 within $14M; time to impact (I)
- Regions (N); ~$180B market (section 2); app 22% of sessions (A)

Adobe CJA (our sandbox)

- 60,000 → 2,592 people; 69% and 77% drop-offs; 25,227 = 36,566 − 11,339 (Fallout)
- 11,610 cart paths: 6,088 to checkout, 1 to email (Flow)
- 28.1% vs 4.7%; 24.5% of buyers, 66% of repeaters; 10.5% overall (A2)
- App 21.5% (n = 265), SMS 11.7% (n = 315) after order one (A5)
- Week 2: 5.6% vs 2.1%; half of engaged repeats in weeks 1–4 (Cohort)
- Category repeat, cashmere 40.7% (A6); 23.0% vs 23.4%, 45.5% (A3b); 4.8% vs 15.0% (AIQ)

Public data (cited)

- ATT opt-in 35% (Adjust, Q2 2025) to 50% (AppsFlyer, Apr 2025)
- Meta average price per ad +12% year on year (Q2 2026 results)
- Meta Advantage+ defaults (2025); TikTok US joint venture (Jan 2026)
- Consumer sentiment record low (UMich, 2026); apparel prices up with tariffs (Cotton Inc.)
- Shein to buy Everlane (May 2026); Amazon ads $19.8B, +26% (Q2 2026)
- Census: 17.1% online (Q2 2026); McKinsey 71%; Tapestry 6.8M; WSI v. Quince (2026)

Derived, or team design

- +29% = $62 ÷ $48; $1.43 = $6M ÷ 4.2M; 60% = ($58M + $14M) ÷ $120M
- 4.6× = 21.5 ÷ 4.7; 2.7× = 5.6 ÷ 2.1; a third = 4.8 ÷ 15.0; ~5,500 = 11,610 − 6,088 − 1
- +6 pts: 6 ÷ 25 = 24% (app), 6 ÷ 16 = 37.5% (email/SMS); ~29% and ~59% after A2→A5 haircuts; web-only ≥ 31% (38a + 29s + 13w = 24)
- Pilot design, not forecasts: 10% holdout, South region, gates at months 3 and 9
- Timing (1h, 24h, delivery, day 7, 21, 60); 30-day recent buyers; gift picks 14 days ahead
- $3.4M = 24.5% × $14M; South tests 28% (Exh. N) × $22M = ~$6.2M, × $58M = ~$16.2M

Case figures are the packet's illustrative estimates, never Quince disclosures. CJA figures come from the team's sandbox, 60,000 people, 1 Jan–30 Apr 2026.

Sources: case data, our CJA project and public research

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Case and Adobe CJA

Quince case packet, "Closing the Loop"
Case Competition World Cup, Graduate Track, 9 Oct 2026; Exhibits A–O, all illustrative

Adobe CJA, Quince Case Data View
Team project: 60,000 people, 125,521 events, 1 Jan–30 Apr 2026 (appendix 9–13)

Adobe Experience League: publishing CJA audiences
Audiences activate via Real-Time CDP or Journey Optimizer
experienceleague.adobe.com/en/docs/analytics-platform/using/cja-compon

Shein to buy Everlane (NPR via Michigan Public, 22 May 2026)
Everlane agreed to be acquired; price not disclosed
michiganpublic.org/2026-05-22/shein-buys-everlane-which-sold-millennia

Gordon, Zettelmeyer, Bhargava & Chapsky (2019)
A Comparison of Approaches to Advertising Measurement. Marketing Science 38(2)
doi.org/10.1287/mksc.2018.1135

Blake, Nosko & Tadelis (2015)
Consumer Heterogeneity and Paid Search Effectiveness. Econometrica 83(1)
doi.org/10.3982/ECTA12423

Market and industry research

Adjust: ATT opt-in rates 2025
35% average opt-in among users shown the prompt, Q2 2025
adjust.com/blog/att-opt-in-rates-2025

AppsFlyer: four years after ATT (Apr 2025)
About 50% of users consent to tracking globally
appsflyer.com/company/newsroom/pr/post-att-growth-2/

Meta Q2 2026 results (Adweek, Jul 2026)
Average price per ad +12% and ad impressions +14% year on year
adweek.com/?p=1954104

Meta Advantage+ as the default campaign setup
Audiences treated as suggestions unless set as limits (Jon Loomer)
jonloomer.com/advantage-plus-campaign-setup-targeting/

TikTok US joint venture (The Register, 23 Jan 2026)
Oracle, Silver Lake and MGX among investors
theregister.com/2026/01/23/jv_announces_tiktok_us_acquisition/

University of Michigan Surveys of Consumers
Record low in May 2026; 46.3 preliminary in October 2026
sca.isr.umich.edu/

Cotton Incorporated, Executive Cotton Update (Jun 2026)
US garment prices rose sharply in early 2026 amid tariffs
ecotextile.com/?p=63440

Competition and market, added: Amazon Q2 2026 ads · Shein/Temu US (CNBC) · Everlane sale (Bloomberg Law) · Fast Retailing FY2025 · Tapestry FY2025 · WSI v. Quince ruling · Census e-commerce · McKinsey personalization

Case figures are the packet's illustrative estimates, never Quince disclosures. Links checked in October 2026.